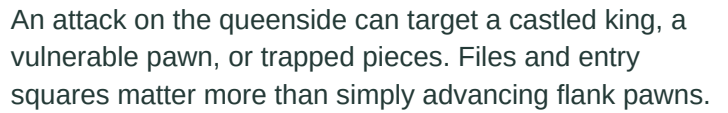


Queenside attacks

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Locate the critical target and which pawn or piece move opens a route toward it. Check whether central counterplay interrupts the plan.

Previous move: 18...Bxg3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

19. Ba6+ Kb8 20. Qb5+ Ka7 21. Qb7#

20.Qb5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From b5 it attacks king on b8 and knight on c6. Recorded reply: **20...Ka7**.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on b7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

The board's left half is not inherently safe. Queen checks and rook entries can make a queenside king as vulnerable as a kingside one.